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LETTER DATED 23 AUGUST 1971 FROM THE PERMANENT REPRESENTATIVE
OF THE KHMER REPUBLIC TO THE UNITED NATIONS ADDRESSED TO THE
PRESIDENT OF THE SECURITY COUNCIL

On instructions from my Government and further to my letter No. 2208 of 1 July 1971 (S/10288, 6 July 1971), I have the honour to communicate the following to you for the information of the members of the Security Council:

On 6 December 1970 the Viet-Cong - North Viet-Khmer arrested a monk named Peou Sam Ang of the pagoda of Tchéng Néam Uhey in the province of Préah Vihear and after taking him to the creek of Kovieng summarily executed him on the pretext that he was an intelligence agent of the Khmer Government.

On 3 April 1971 an unidentified monk who was travelling on the road from Kompong-Thom to Kovieng (Préah Vihear) was stopped by the Viet-Cong - North Viet-Khmers in the vicinity of Phnom Dêk. Accused of espionage, he was executed then and there.

On 5 May 1971 two monks named Im Son Kai and You Pa, from the Kéy Deang pagoda, creek of Kompong-Svay, were arrested at the village of Kank Ngoun by the Viet-Cong - North Viet-Khmer invaders, taken towards the village of Mont O, and systematically searched. After taking the sum of 10,000 reals, a gold amulet and a wristwatch found on the person of the Venerable Im Son Kai (articles which had been given him by his parents), the invaders forced him to dig his own grave and killed him with a burst of machine-gun fire when he attempted to flee. The fate of the Venerable You Pa, held under surveillance at the pagoda of Sreng and then at Phnom Santok, is unknown.

On 30 May 1971 the Venerable Head of the Sangkum Monichant pagoda, accused by the Viet-Cong - North Viet-Khmers of espionage and co-operation with the National Khmer Armed Forces, took refuge in the pagoda of Kompong-Thom, which is under the protection of the Khmer authorities.

I wish to reiterate before international public opinion the firm and vigorous protest of the Khmer Government against these acts of systematic persecution committed by the Viet-Cong - North Viet-Khmer aggressors against Khmer Buddhist monks who, by virtue of the teachings of the Great Master, are imbued with the spirit of pacifism. These criminal acts constitute a flagrant violation of international laws and customs and clearly reveal the true imperialist aims of the Viet-Cong - North Viet-Khmer invaders.

The Government of the Khmer Republic holds the Government of the Democratic Republic of Viet-Nam and the so-called Provisional Revolutionary Government of South Viet-Nam fully responsible for all the extremely grave consequences of this situation and reserves the right to take the necessary action to protect the defenceless civil and religious population and the principles of freedom recognized in the Universal Declaration of Human Rights.

I should be grateful if you would have the text of this communication circulated as a Security Council document.

(Signed) TRUCMO CANO
Permanent Representative of
The Khmer Republic